

Owen Hejna

Ecologist and Educator

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Website · LinkedIn · GitHub

Education

B.S., Ecology

Graduated *cum laude*, May 2024

Loyola University Chicago

University Research: Laboratory of Bioinformatics, Laboratory of Aquatic Ecology, Urban Agriculture Program

Professional Experience

Secretive Marshbird Coordinator

Since February 2026 Self-employed, Contractor

Program Instructor

Since February 2026 Evanston Ecology Center, Evanston, IL

Community Science Coordinator

April – December 2025

Urban Wildlife Institute at Lincoln Park Zoo, Chicago, IL

Summer Research Intern

June – September 2024

Urban Wildlife Institute at Lincoln Park Zoo, Chicago, IL

DNA Barcoding of Neotropical Fishes Intern

June – August 2023

The Field Museum, Chicago, IL

Shoreline Maintenance Technician

June – August 2022

Chicago Botanic Garden, Glencoe, IL

Professional Affiliations

Chicago Ornithological Society

Since November 2025

Member

Urban Rivers

Since June 2025

Educator

National Society of Collegiate Scholars

2020 – 2024

Member

Scientific Articles

Planet Forward

Published October 2025

Chicago's people-powered Bat Tracker: Citizen scientists seek a different bat signal

Attended Conferences

Urban Wildlife Information Network Summit

September 2025

Certifications

Acoustic Bat Call Identification

Vesper Bat Detection Services

Issued May 2025

Mandated Reporter

Illinois Department of Children and Family Services

Issued May 2025

Educational Programs

West Ridge Nature Park 10th Anniversary Fest

Environmental Educator (bats)

September 2025

Bat Tracker Big Sit

Event Programmer and Lead

July 2025